**Aashish Sunar**
aashishsunar.01@gmail.com | LinkedIn | GitHub: Aashisho1o1

September 21, 2026

Hiring Team
Esri
Redlands, CA

Dear Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Software Development Engineer Internship at Esri. I have been building on ArcGIS on my own for a while, and I am curious to learn more about ArcGIS and the rest of Esri's tools from mentors and fellow interns in a collaborative, team-oriented setting, so I am very much looking forward to this internship.

The project I would most want to talk about is BlueHabit, a route planner that finds walkable paths for wheelchair users and residents with vision loss by pulling air quality and satellite data through ESRI GeoAI and reasoning over it with Claude. Four of us built it over a weekend and it placed fourth out of more than thirty teams at CGU's Ethical AI Hackathon. What stayed with me was how much of the hard part Esri had already solved, and how much was left to do in making the output legible to somebody who is not a GIS analyst.

Before that I built GeoAssist, a React and TypeScript app that lets someone ask a plain English question about hospitals, schools, or cities and get an answer off public ArcGIS Feature Services. A language model turns the question into a structured request with WHERE clauses and field selection, and the results come back as map graphics you can click. I built the interface on Esri's web components and the Calcite Design System rather than rolling my own, partly to learn the stack properly and partly because the accessibility work was already done better than I would have done it. I added ARIA live regions and keyboard navigation on top, since a map you cannot operate without a mouse is not really finished.

The rest of my background lines up with the projects listed in the posting more closely than I expected. Test automation with language models is close to my current work at CGU's AI for Humanity Lab, where I wrote a TypeScript and Playwright tool that loads a live page and measures whether a required AI disclosure is actually visible to a person, rather than merely present in the page source. Disaster response on real feeds is what I did at Soka University, where an alerting service I wrote in Python reads NASA's live event feed, measures distance from each active wildfire or storm to alumni addresses, and tells the alumni office which of 2,000+ people sit in the path. DevOps work in Python, Docker, and GitHub Actions has been the quiet half of every job I have had, including the retail platform I spent two years building for a business in Nepal that now carries 200+ customers.

I am finishing an MS in Information Systems and Technology at Claremont Graduate University in May 2027, and I can commit to a consecutive twelve week onsite internship starting that May or June. I would be glad to walk through any of this in more detail, and to hear what the team is working on now.

Thank you for your time.

Sincerely,
Aashish Sunar